



The Poor Man's Guardian started in 1830 by Henry Hetherington. It was part of a group of "Unstamped" newspapers that refused to pay a high tax on newspapers.

It shared news and stories about working people and called for fair taxes and voting rights. Hetherington also spoke in public about these issues.

It became the most popular of these papers and helped pressure the government to lower the newspaper tax in 1836.

The money it made helped workers and strike support. Even though it only lasted four years, it had a big impact on workers' rights and later reform movements.

Friends, Brethren, and Fellow-Countrymen,

OUR "appeal," as it is called—or rather the appeal of our friends—has turned out as we anticipated;—the conviction of Messrs. Birnie, Hall, and Robinson has been *confirmed*:—it has been decided by their "sapient worships," that distinct and nameless papers written by the same author, and published irregularly, form only one connected paper, bearing one and the same name, and published at stated periods—or, in fine, that the papers written by the "POOR MAN'S GUARDIAN," are within the meaning of *Castlereagh's Act*. Be it so; we wished to avoid "the law" as we would a very nuisance; we wished—though at great inconvenience—to keep as close as possible without actually trespassing on the common of which this act of tyranny has deprived us,—but we find it impossible; "the law" is made behind our backs—without our consent—kept secret from us—and when discovered, is unintelligible,—or, whether intelligible or not, it is to be interpreted by the *paid servants* of those who enforce it—and, consequently, escape from it is hopeless! Be it so, we say: we are prepared for the fight; it is a mere *legal* one on the part of our persecutors, but a *moral* one on ours; we know that we must suffer, but we are content to do so for the benefit of our fellow-creatures; we have before our eyes the fatal examples of all who have ever advocated the *truth*; but we shrink not from the worst, be our reward the cross of agony itself, on which Christ *expiated his* "SEDITION;" and be our doctrines, like his—pure and just as they are—rejected by all mankind; or, be they like his, only received to be distorted—even by those who profess the most to venerate them—into an authority for every species of rapacity and injustice—still we are prepared. Better—far better not to be, than be as we are! Yes, we buckle on our armour of patience and perseverance—we draw forth our sword of reason, and we brave the whole host of tyranny! Defiance is our only remedy;—we cannot be a slave in all; we submit to much—for it is impossible to be wholly consistent—but we will try, step by step, the power of RIGHT against MIGHT, and we will begin by protecting and upholding this grand bulwark and defence of all our rights—this key to all our liberties—THE FREEDOM OF THE PRESS—

the press, too, of the IGNORANT and the POOR! we have taken upon ourselves its protection, and we will never abandon our post: we will *die* rather.

The fight is begun, and we must cast off the trammels both of disguise and fear; we cannot avoid the struggle, and we must meet it manfully:—no more *evasion*; we will not *trespass*, but deny the authority of our "lords" to enclose the *common* against us; we will *demand* our right, nor treat but with *contempt* the despotic "law" which would deprive us of it; we will trample it under our feet—and resist to the last any *power* that may attempt to enforce it.

To you—friends and brethren—you whose cause we are advocating—whose rights we demand—whose liberties we defend—whose interests we espouse—to you we now appeal, not to let us fight our perilous battle singlehanded; we look to you for support; we ask you not to incur danger or expense—we desire not the risk of interests or person—we ask you merely to purchase, with your weekly pennies, and *read*, and *mark*, and *learn*, and *inwardly digest*, our "news-paper," to be called henceforward "THE POOR MAN'S GUARDIAN;" which will contain "news, intelligence, and occurrences," and "remarks and observations thereon," and "upon matters in Church and State, tending, decidedly, to excite hatred and contempt of the Government and Constitution of the tyranny of this country, as BY LAW established," and also "to vilify the ABUSES of Religion"—and will be "printed in the United Kingdom, for sale, and published periodically" (every Saturday) "in yearly parts and weekly numbers, at intervals not exceeding twenty-six days, and will not exceed two sheets, and will be published for a less sum than Sixpence" (to wit) the sum of ONE PENNY, "exclusive of the duty imposed by the 38 Geo. III. c. 78, and the 60 Geo. III. c. 9," or any other acts whatsoever, and despite the "laws" or the will and pleasure of any tyrant or any body of tyrants whatsoever, any thing hereinbefore, or any where-else, contained to the contrary notwithstanding.

MIDDLESEX SESSIONS, Saturday, July 2.
(Before Francis Const, and seven or eight Magistrates.)

PENNY PAPERS.
Henry Hetherington appealed against the conviction obtained by the Commissioners of Stamps before the PAID Magistrates of Bow-street Police Office.